

Glass and Windshield Claims Guide

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Audience: Claims adjusters

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This guide expands on the glass-only claim handling referenced in claim intake and the `is_glass_only` claim classification used throughout Meridian Mutual's claims data, with the specific coverage and payout rules for windshield and glass damage.

1. Coverage Basis

Windshield and other glass damage (side windows, rear window, sunroof) is covered under Part C (Other Than Collision), since glass breakage from a road hazard, weather event, or vandalism is not a collision with another vehicle or object in the collision sense used by Part D. A glass claim arising from a collision that also damaged other parts of the vehicle is instead adjudicated as part of the overall Part D claim, not separately under Part C.

2. Full Glass Coverage (No Deductible)

Where the Declarations page shows Full Glass Coverage selected, a covered glass claim is paid with no deductible applied, regardless of the standard Part C deductible that would otherwise apply to other comprehensive losses. This is a purchased enhancement, not a default — its presence or absence on the Declarations page is checked before any glass claim payout is computed.

3. Glass Claims Without Full Glass Coverage

Where Full Glass Coverage is not selected, a glass claim is paid under standard Part C terms, meaning the applicable Part C deductible is subtracted from the repair or replacement cost by the deterministic calculation service, the same as any other Part C loss.

4. Repair Versus Replacement

A chip or small crack that can be safely repaired (per the repair vendor's assessment) is generally repaired rather than replaced, both because repair is less costly and because repair typically does not trigger a deductible even without Full Glass Coverage in many policy structures — the Policy Wording section governing this specific repair-no-deductible provision is checked and cited before applying it, since it is a narrower benefit than full glass coverage itself and not universal across all policy versions.

5. Advanced Driver Assistance System Recalibration

A windshield replacement on a vehicle equipped with camera-based driver assistance features (lane-departure warning, automatic emergency braking) typically requires a calibration procedure after replacement for those systems to function correctly. This calibration cost is a component of the glass claim's total cost, not a separate claim, and is included in the repair vendor's invoice reviewed under the same reasonableness standard as any other repair cost.

6. Frequency of Glass Claims

Multiple glass claims within a policy period are each adjudicated independently on their own facts — glass damage from road debris or vandalism is generally not treated as pattern evidence of fraud the way repeated, similar-narrative bodily injury claims might be (Fraud Indicators Guide, Section 8), since glass damage has plausible high-frequency causes unrelated to policyholder conduct. This does not eliminate SIU referral where other fraud indicators are independently present.

7. Vandalism-Caused Glass Damage

Glass damage from vandalism is covered under Part C using the same rules described above; where vandalism is suspected, a police report is requested consistent with the general evidentiary standard applied to other vandalism and theft claims, though a police report is not itself a coverage precondition for the glass claim to be paid.

8. Documentation Standard

A glass claim file documents: the cause of the glass damage, whether Full Glass Coverage applies (Section 2), whether repair or replacement was performed (Section 4), any recalibration cost included (Section 5), and the final computed payout including or excluding the deductible as applicable.